

The American apologist Josh McDowell once argued that the evidence for Christ's bodily Resurrection was strong enough to convict in any court of law. Kirill Eskov—a Russian palaeontologist with a detective's instincts and a novelist's nerve—takes him at his word.

Approaching the Gospels as a classical English whodunit, where every clue must fit and none may be discarded, Eskov works through the case "knot" by knot: Pilate's strange mercy, the missing body, the contradictions between John and the Synoptics. Granting his suspects a "presumption of honesty," he arrives at a wholly natural explanation—and then dramatizes it. In the book's second half, the chief of Pilate's secret service, the tribune Afranius, lays out Operation Ichthys: a covert intelligence scheme to manufacture a pacifist faith for the Roman East.

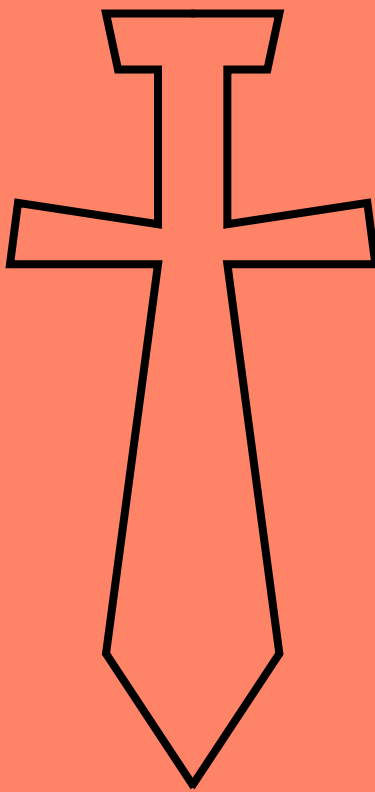
Equal parts counter-apologetic, historical reconstruction, and espionage fiction, *The Gospel of Afranius* reopens the oldest story in the West as an unsolved case.

The Gospel of Afranius

Kirill Eskov

The Gospel of Afranius

A Detective Investigation into Sacred History



Kirill Eskov

Translated by Zachary Baumgartner